

Ashampoo Antivirus 1.40

Good for free

FREE



From the looks of it, Ashampoo Antivirus is aimed at the home user. It lets you scan hard drives, memory, removable discs, etc., with a click of a button. Scheduling of scans can be set for a particular folder on a particular day, date, or time. Shell integration means one can right-click on a folder to scan it.

Scanning doesn't take too much processor resources. Our CPU utilisation levels floated around 40 per cent, and memory consumption peaked at around 60 MB. This means it is a light anti-virus to run and use on a day-to-day basis.

The interface itself is probably the highlight of the entire package. It has a colourful set of icons and themes and an easy-to-

understand layout. There's even skin support, though we're wondering why somebody would want to change the default skin of an anti-virus!

Customising the various levels of strictness of scans and frequency of updates is as easy as moving a slider up or down. Logs of all scans are kept within the program, and can be exported whenever needed to HTML.

Documentation isn't required for an anti-virus as simple as this, but is available as a Windows Help file. Screenshots in the Help illustrate the various features and tasks.

A price of \$29.99 (Rs. 1,350) means it is a bit on the higher side. Additional features such as inbuilt pop-up blockers, anti-spyware,



and parental control would have been appreciated.

Ashampoo Antivirus, in sum, isn't cheap either. There are a lot more anti-

virus and security suites available at similar price tags too. Those home users who want an extremely easy-to-use, standalone anti-virus software should be buying it. We've exclusively bundled the full version of this software on this month's Digit DVD.

Web site: www.ashampoo.com
Price: \$29.99 (Rs. 1,350)

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★
Features	★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

Symantec Ghost Solution Suite 2.0

Spook your worries away!

There is nothing more painful than reinstalling your operating system and then going through hours and sometimes days of customizing and installing your favourite software one after another. Symantec is well known for not just its Norton Antivirus but also the well known data backup tool—Ghost. This latest release of the suite is aimed at both network administrators as well as standalone users.

Ghost Solution Suite 2.0 comes with the latest Norton Ghost 11.0 which is a DOS based application. Creating images from partitions or hard disks from it is easy and straight forward. The interface has changed a little over the years. Restoring or creating images isn't limited to local drives anymore.

Ghostcast offers a unique way of accessing

images from the server over the network. Opening and extracting certain folders and files from an image can be done with a little utility called Ghost Explorer.

Administrating the Ghost enabled systems is made possible by the Ghost Console which gives the user an overview of all the computers on the network running the client. One of the main features with the Ghost Solution Suite is allowing the administrator to run a server with a session and then multiple clients connecting over the network to either dump or access images from the server.

The whole suite comes packed with pretty much everything a network administrator would need to setup new machines. In addition to this, upgrading from a current OS such as Windows XP to Vista is also

made easy as the Ghost console automatically can backup all the necessary settings and system files. The application even goes to the extent of checking the machines configurations to make sure they can run Vista properly. Such features are made to be very customizable. The printed documentation shouldn't be of much use as it's more of a brief of the features available. The real documentation is in the form of well explained interactive flash animations and screenshots on the CD.

The entire package is very good for the network administrator managing several machines on the network; although a home user could have done with



just a plain install of Norton Ghost. With a price tag of \$39.20, it is a good buy for anyone who has to make clean installs of customized operating systems on several machines very often plus it also doubles up as a data backup utility.

Contact: Ingram Micro India (P) Ltd
Phone: 080-26564445
E-mail: Deenu.m@ingrammicro.co.in
Web site: www.symantec.com
Price: \$39.20

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★
Features	★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★